

SAAJ - a Mehfil by the Water

15-Day Meta Paid Acquisition Campaign · Niazi Nizami Brothers · Radisson Blu Plaza Delhi Airport · 26 September 2026

27

paid tickets,
all from ads

₹47,720

ticket sales
from ads

2.59×

gross ROAS

3.06×

net ROAS

19 → 125

Instagram
followers

For SAAJ – a Mehfil by the Water, an intimate Sufi/Qawwali evening featuring the Niazi Nizami Brothers at Radisson Blu Plaza Delhi Airport on 26 September 2026, I planned and ran a 15-day Meta paid acquisition campaign from scratch.

The starting point

The Instagram account had only 19 followers and no posts — every post on it was created by me. It had no verification, little social proof and a brand-new Ads Manager account. The product was a niche cultural event with premium tickets at ₹1,500–₹2,500, not including food and drinks. There were no sponsors and no bulk messaging tool, and the team was just me and the client. I made up for the small budget with hands-on execution, fast creative iteration and manual selling.

Positioning and credibility

I positioned the event as “**Delhi’s 1st ever poolside Mehfil,**” using the five-star poolside setting as a core part of the premium experience. I added scarcity and FOMO through the intimate 100-guest capacity. To build trust for a new, low-credibility account, I:

- ran **partnership ads** with the Niazi Nizami Brothers through Meta Ads Manager, so ads could draw on the artists’ own presence;
- rewrote the **Instagram bio** to include the organiser’s name and handle, borrowing credibility from her 17K-follower audience;
- **renamed the page** to include “Baithak” and “Mehfil in Delhi” so it would show up when people searched for a baithak or mehfil in Delhi;
- sold tickets through **District and BookMyShow**, which added platform-level trust.

Conversion rate optimisation

I worked on conversion at several points in the funnel:

- **Bio link:** I put the booking link in the Instagram bio so buying took as few steps as possible.
- **Typeable link:** I created a TinyURL with a simple alias so people could type the link easily.
- **Two campaign routes:** I set up sales campaigns that sent people straight to District and BookMyShow, and ran them alongside sales campaigns with automated messaging, to compare cost per lead.
- **Manual follow-up:** After the first automated message, I personally messaged leads. This made up for having no budget for a messaging tool, and it also showed me each person’s main hesitation before buying.

Campaign build and testing

I set up the Ads Manager structure myself, with simple campaigns and clear naming so they were easy to manage and optimise. I created and edited all the creatives and videos.

- **Targeting:** I tested interest-based audiences including concerts, music festivals, general music interest, high- and mid-value goods, and top 21–30% household income. The top 21–30% income segment performed best and became the core audience for the rest of the campaign.
- **Creative:** I tested many videos and statics built around the location, the area, the experience, the artists and their repertoire. I used two or three of the Niazi Nizami Brothers' best-known songs as hooks to make the artists familiar to cold audiences. The best performer was a reel that combined footage from the artists' past event with their most famous song.
- **Early traction:** The first two or three sales came from Instagram boosting. After that I refined the full Meta setup.

Results

- **Awareness:** About ₹1,000 went to awareness, which grew followers from 19 to 125. Three videos reached roughly 20K, 25K and 35K views.
- **Spend:** Of a ₹19,385 budget, ₹981 went unused. Meta spend was ₹18,404 gross, or about ₹15,597 net of 18% GST.
- **Tickets from ads:** All 27 paid tickets came from the ads.
- **Return:** The 27 tickets brought in ₹47,720. That is about **2.59x gross ROAS** and **3.06x net ROAS**, or roughly **₹32,123 in sales above net ad spend**.
- **Attendance:** The event filled close to capacity through paid tickets plus complimentary tickets the client gave out. I don't claim that the advertising alone filled the 100-person event.

Key takeaway

In 15 days, starting from almost no digital credibility, I built and ran an end-to-end paid acquisition campaign that produced measurable paid demand. The main drivers were premium positioning, borrowed credibility through partnership ads and the organiser's audience, recognisable content hooks, structured audience and creative testing, several layers of conversion optimisation, and hands-on manual selling.